

Graphics card jargons demystified

Often while dealing with graphics cards you might come across certain terms and jargons which may leave you dumbfounded. You might face the same problem when reading reviews or specification details of these cards. Worry no more, as the comprehensive list below would solve your graphics cards woes forever.

PCI-E – expands as Peripheral Component Interconnect Express. PCI -E basically connects a computer's motherboard to a graphics card. It's a high speed channel used to make the graphics card integrate with the PC. PCI-E has replaced AGP, PCI over the years.

GPU – a graphics processing unit helps in the building and appearance of images on the screen. The term GPU was made famous by NVIDIA in 1999. A GPU can be present on a graphics card or a motherboard.

Anti aliasing – is a technique in which lines are made to be appeared smooth on the screen. Known as jaggies these lines occur because the monitor does not have enough resolution to represent a smooth line.

Anisotropic filtering – represented as AF, it helps in enhancing the quality of images which have a large expanse such



Anisotropic filtering compared

as landscapes. This technique basically reduces the blur in the image by not only aliasing the image quality but also preserves details giving a sharper image.

Core clock – actual speed at which the graphics processor on a card operates is core clock. This is generally measured in

MHz. When the core clock is increased in order to achieve a performance boost it's called overclocking. This can be done by using third party apps.

Memory clock – this helps in knowing the amount of memory bandwidth a graphics card has. In other words it's the clock speed of the onboard memory of the video card. Core clock tells you what the PC bases its decision on and memory clock tells you how fast this information gets to the GPU.

Shader clock – is faster than core clock or memory clock. Shader clock helps in boosting the performance of shader heavy games like Crysis. A shader is used to calculate the rendering effects in graphics and enhancing this to achieve better results is known as shader clock.

Frame buffer – think of frame buffer as the temporary storage place where a complete image is stored which is displayed on the monitor. This is generally saved on the memory chips on the graphics card.

Types of display ports on graphics cards

D-Sub: D-subminiature or D-sub is a common type of connector class in computers. This connects the monitor to the motherboard. It transmits analog signal.



HDMI: High definition multimedia interface is a connector type which is used to transmit uncompressed digital data.

DVI: Digital visual interface is used to transfer digital data between a source device and a display device



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